2000
Debt-ridden and with his acting career flagging, Bachchan approaches Juhu neighbour Yash Chopra for work. A part in his son Aditya Chopra's ***Mohabbatein*** ensues. There's no looking back.

July 2, 2000
The first episode of Star TV's quiz show ***Kaun Banega Crorepati*** airs. Viewership breaks the circuit barrier. Besides a brief run by SRK in season three, Bachchan as *KBC* host is still going strong in 2022.

2001
ABCL reinvents itself as AB Corp.

2003
Pairs with old co-star Hema Malini for family tearjerker ***Baghban***. As his career looks up, in 2004, Jaya Bachchan takes a dig at the Gandhis, saying those who brought her husband into politics deserted him in times of crisis. Rahul Gandhi defends his family. Amitabh responds with "*Woh raja hai, hum runk hain*".

2005
The films begin to flower again. Earns praise for ***Sarkar***; wins his second National Award for best actor for ***Black***, his only collaboration with Sanjay Leela Bhansali. Also, shakes a leg with son Abhishek and daughter-in-law-to-be Aishwarya Rai in the hit '*Kajra Re*' (***Bunty aur Babli***).

2007
A long-standing collaboration begins with filmmaker R. Balki with the release of ***Cheeni Kum***. ***Nishabd*** sees him in a quaint, affecting pairing with Jiah Khan.


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Photograph by BANDEEP SINGH

April 17, 2008
Starts a blog sharing anecdotes from his personal and professional life. Has rarely missed an entry since then.

2009
Wins his third National Award for Balki's ***Paa***, co-starring Abhishek.

2010
Becomes brand ambassador for Gujarat, a move that angers his former party Congress, who see it as him endorsing then CM Narendra Modi.

2013
Makes his Hollywood debut in Baz Luhrmann's adaptation of ***The Great Gatsby***.

2015
Yet another National Award, this time for essaying an eccentric septuagenarian battling constipation in Shoojit Sircar's ***Piku***. Fully re-established as a viable, if old, protagonist.

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